

revised Aerospace & Defence Industrial Policy 2022 to attract investments and creating direct and indirect employment prospects for nearly 1 lakh people in Aerospace & Defence sector over a period of 10 years. For creating a vibrant hub for start-ups, the Tamil Nadu Industrial Investment Corporation Limited (TIIC) is implementing New Entrepreneurs cum Enterprise Development Scheme (NEEDS) for assisting educated youth to become first generation entrepreneurs. Since May 2021, 240 units were sanctioned Rs.196.52 crore loan under this scheme.

Going a step further to enable building affordable houses, TANCEM introduced a new brand "Valimai" to sell the cement produced from the new plant at an affordable price which is comparatively lesser than the price of cement being sold by private cement manufacturers. The new brand was launched by CM Stalin and 10,40,328 MT of Valimai cement has been sold so far.

In Thirupurur area, Part of chengalpattu district, salt production commenced in June, 2022, where the Tamil Nadu Salt Corporation Limited (TNSC) developed salt works in 500 acres in the 1st phase at a project cost of Rs.5.90 crore. TNSC launched the open market sale of Crystal Iodised Salt and Refined Free Flow Iodised salt in the new brand name "Neithal Salt". CM Stalin launched the scheme of providing relief assistance of Rs.5,000/- to salt workers during the rainy season. Relief assistance of Rs.6.41 crore has been disbursed to 12,842 salt workers families.

A mineral rich state, revenue generated from mineral resources is Rs.1572.84 crore (Tentative) in the financial year 2022-23. An amount of Rs.45.27 crore has been collected as green fund aimed at securing and restoring the abandoned quarries and mines - for reclamation, restoration, and rehabilitation of abandoned quarries / mines in 36 districts of the state. A geo-park is also being established to protect the rare heritage in the district of Perambalur.

Youthful Sporting Spirit

Tamil Nadu has a vibrant youth welfare and sports development department which has witnessed an aggressive revamp infusing new vigour with funds being pumped into it liberally and a fresh vision ahead to compete in world tournaments. A state

which has produced world-class sports persons across several disciplines is working towards achieving a dominating space in the sports category for which sports infrastructure are being revamped and new state-of-art sports campuses are being readied, incentives, allowances and scholarships are being given to the deserving and talent hunt is also a focus area. Winners of medals have been given hefty prize money as incentives and even Silambam one of the traditional and pre-historic Indian martial arts of Tamil Nadu, has been included in the 3% sports quota for the employment.

The Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu inaugurated the 400 meter synthetic athletic track, multi-purpose training hall and residential building for teachers in Tamil Nadu Physical Education and Sports University in January, 2023. Also the Chief Minister's State Youth Award cash amount has been enhanced from Rs.50,000/- to Rs.100000. Cash prizes too were announced for athletes who won medals in national and international tournaments such as Ms. S. Ridhu Varshini for having secured Gold medal in team event in the World Youth Archery Championship held at Wroclaw, Poland who got a cash incentive of Rs 6 lakhs, Thiru. T. Mariyappan for having secured Silver medal in High Jump in the Paralympics 2020 held at Tokyo, Japan received Rs. 2 crore and a sum of Rs.92.00 lakh has been sanctioned to Thiru. Anand Viswanathan, Thiru. VR Aravindh Chithambaram, R. Pragganandhaa, R. Vaishali and Srinath Narayanan (Non-playing captain, coach) in Indian Team in the 1st FIDE Online Olympiad Chess Championship 2020 secured Gold Medal and Rs 57.50 lakh was sanctioned for the coaches including Thiru. B. Adhiban, B. Savitha Shri and Srinath Narayanan (Men's team coach) and M. Shyam Sundar (Women's Team Coach) in Indian Team in the FIDE Online Olympiad Chess Championship 2021 secured Bronze Medal. High Cash Incentive worth Rs. 3,91,00,000 was sanctioned to the 4 sportspersons and their coaches who had won medals in the 22nd Commonwealth Games held at Birmingham, England from 28th July to 8th August 2022 Even the ELITE sportspersons under Special Scholarship Scheme were sanctioned Rs.83,68,900 and a sum of Rs.1,39,55,084 to the sportspersons under Mission International Medal Scheme. Hosting the 44th Chess Olympiad 2022 too incurred funds to the tune of



Rs.114.39 crore.

To encourage participation of tribal youth in sports, Rs.25.00 lakh was sanctioned as recurring expenditure towards Talent Identification among the Tribes of Thali, Thenkanikottai and its surrounding areas in Krishnagiri District under Day Boarder Scheme and World Beater's Talent Spotting scheme. Also, the expenditure towards Arignar Anna Bicycle race has been hiked from Rs 1 lakh to Rs. 38 lakh. To meet the recurring expenditure towards setting up of Sports Hostel of Excellence for college girls in Katpadi, Vellore District funds worth Rs.69 lakh has been set apart for the purpose. Rs. 30 crore was allocated for maintenance of modern stadia under the control of Sports Development Authority of Tamil Nadu Rs 30 crore.

A Centre of Excellence in Table Tennis Academy built at a cost of Rs. 12.60 crore at Tamil Nadu Physical Education and Sports University, the Centre of Excellence in Bio Mechanics Laboratory constructed at a cost of Rs. 13.12 crore and Centre of Excellence for Badminton Academy constructed at a cost of Rs. 13.33 crore at Tamil Nadu Physical Education and Sports University was inaugurated on 14 March, 2022 alongwith the Traditional Kalaripayattu and Silambam Training Centre built at a cost of Rs. 1.60 crore and a girls hostel for 400 students constructed at a cost of Rs.14.59 crore, all on the same premises.

To meet recurring expenses, financial aid to the State Sports Association was enhanced from Rs.3,31,40,000 to Rs.4,00,00,000. Even for the outstanding sportspersons who are needy, their pension has been enhanced from Rs.3,000 to Rs.6,000 per month..

To encourage youth participation in National Cadet Corp (NCC), Rs. 2,98,020/ was sanctioned consequent to the enhancement of Microlight Flying Training to the NCC Cadets, Rs.72, 98,805 was accorded towards the expansion of NCC in Coastal Districts and a sum of Rs. 1 crore was allocated for the ongoing / proposed NCC Cadets Camps and training for the year 2022-23.

Celebrating Art, Culture & Heritage

To showcase the treasure trove of Tamil Nadu's art, culture, tourism and tourists spots, the Tamil Nadu has been bullish on promoting the state on prestigious national and international events and sponsoring several festivals and events as well. The World Travel Market-2022 (WTM-2022) London, the "MATTA Fair-

